First News

26 Mar 2026

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

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Global, Regional Markets

Wall Street closed higher on Wednesday as optimism over a potential 15-point U.S. ceasefire proposal to end the war with Iran sparked a rebound. The major indexes regained ground after Tuesday's losses, bolstered by a sharp decline in oil prices and falling Treasury yields.

Oil remained sharply lower amid a diplomatic push by the US to end the war with Iran, though pared an earlier slide after Iranian media reported that a ceasefire is not viable at the moment.

Iran said it rejected a US ceasefire proposal and maintained attacks on Israel and Gulf Arab states
BRENT 98.16
CRUDE 91.21

Brent fell 5.44% % to $94.78 a barrel even as the Strait of Hormuz remained effectively shut.

Iran navy says fired missiles at US aircraft carrier

- Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) claimed to have fired missiles at the U.S. aircraft carrier USS Abraham Lincoln in the Gulf region
- No confirmation from US Navy

GLOBAL FUNDS : ASIAN FLOWS TUESDAY 3/24/26

- **BOUGHT EQUITIES** Malaysia $27.1 million Thailand $18.9 million
- **SOLD EQUITIES** India $1.2 billion South Korea $1.21 billion Taiwan $332.7 million Indonesia $40 million Vietnam $21.5 million Philippines $12.6 million

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Tan Ruisong, the former chairman of Aviation Industry Corp. of China (AVIC), has been sentenced to death with a two-year reprieve for accepting over 613 million yuan in bribes between 1998 and 2024, alongside convictions for corruption and leaking inside information.

Southeast Asian stock markets closed higher, driven by a recovery in investor sentiment following tentative hopes for a resolution to ongoing Middle East tensions.

- Philippines PSEi recovered through bargain hunting despite the peso hitting a record low of ₱60.10 per US dollar.

Heineken NV will phase out large-scale brewing at its Tuas facility in Singapore by the end of 2027, shifting production to Malaysia and Vietnam to optimize supply chain efficiency.

Prolonged Middle East conflict threatens Thailand's tourism recovery, potentially losing 3 million tourists and $4.6B in revenue if the war lasts 6 months. Rising airfares, flight rerouting, reduced traveler confidence from Europe and the Middle East are fueling this downturn.

The MSCI Asia Pacific Index rose as much as 2.3%, the most since March 10, with chipmakers TSMC and Samsung among the biggest boosts. Benchmarks rose more than 2.5% each in South Korea, Japan and Taiwan.

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Asia-Pacific

	3/24/2026	3/25/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	46,208	46,429	0.48%
S&P 500	6,581	6,591	0.15%
NASDAQ	21,946	21,929	-0.08%
PCOMP	5,899.00	6,044.00	2.46%
NKY	51,515.00	53,749.00	4.34%
SHCOMP	3813	3931	3.09%
HSI	24,382.00	25,335.00	3.91%
KOSPI	5405	5642	4.38%
SENSEX	72,696.00	75,273.00	3.54%
TWSE	32,722	33,439	2.19%
ASX200	8365	8534	2.02%
BURSAKLCI	1720	1716	-0.23%
JCI	7106	7302	2.76%
STI	4841	4904	1.30%
SET	929	968	4.20%
VNINDEX	1591	1658	4.21%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Commodities - Metals & Agriculture

	3/24/2026	3/25/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude	89.78	91.39	1.79%
Brent Crude	100.92	103.35	2.41%
Gold (Comex)	4465	4566	2.26%
Silver (Comex)	69.58	72.02	3.51%
Platinum Spot	1893	1933.32	2.13%
Copper (Comex)	548	552.7	0.86%
Nickel	7.5373	7.8056	3.56%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.5%	80	80	0.00%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.8%	94.5	94.5	0.00%
Coal	140.5	137.55	-2.10%
Corn	461.25	467	1.25%
Wheat	592	599.75	1.31%
Cocoa	3180	3133	-1.48%
Sugar	15.52	15.55	0.19%

Strategy

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Philippines

President Marcos Signs Law That Can Halt Oil Tax Ahead of Transport Strike

President Marcos Jr. officially declared a State of National Energy Emergency in the Philippines, which have severely disrupted global oil supply chains and caused local pump prices to more than double

The Philippines currently holds a fuel supply for approximately 45 days. President Marcos expressed confidence in maintaining a steady flow by procuring an additional 1 million barrels for buffer stock and exploring non-traditional sources like Russia.

Global Investors Buying Wed 3/25/26
AP APX AUB DNL DMC EW ICT LTG MER MWC MRC MAC NIKL PCOR PX PNB SGP SPNEC SHLPH TEL

Global Investors Net Selling Wed 3/25/26 ALI AEV AREIT BPI BDO CNVRG CBC GTCAP JFC MYNLD MBT OGP PGOLD PLUS RCR RLC SCC SM SMPH URC

BSP awards
P70.0b ($1. 17b) term deposits offered at its weekly auction on March 25, 2026.
7-Days: The average rate of 4.2308% is approximately 0.054% lower than the previous rate of 4.2331%.
14-Days: There is 0% change, as the average rate matches the previous rate of 4.8216%

Philippine House Committee on Justice voted overwhelmingly (34-1) to issue a subpoena for the Statements of Assets, Liabilities, and Net Worth (SALNs) of Vice President Sara Duterte, covering the years 2007–2013, 2016–2022, and 2022–2025.

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Philippines

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6044 107pts., -82%

Range 5960-6044

Breadth 118 (+) 81 (-) 54 (unch)

Block Php921Mn **Volume** 1.14bn
Value Php7.36bn

Share buyback sm ict opm spmh meg

52wk H: none
52wk L: atn bhi eei idc medic om rci tech vlc zhi

Overbought – none
Oversold – lbc tech at gtcap xg gsm om atn

Active	Value
ICT	1220
BDO	426
ALI	277
SM	252
MBT	249
BPI	227
GTCAP	191
SMPH	166
APX	149

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Foreign Trade

NFB(S)	$3.739mn
Total Month FB	$6.160mn
YTD NFB	$186.586mn
FB	3,769,122,807.76
FS	3,544,430,385.41
NFB(S)	-224,692,422.35
TOTAL	7,313,553,193.17

Foreign Funds Bought
aub ew pnb secb dhi slf ap mer mwc pcor sgp shlph spc spnec cnpf dnl emi fcg mwide cosco dmc jgs ltg cli meg mrc mreit dito tel ceb ict mac sti web sevn apx at nikl px

Foreign Funds Sold
bdo bpi cbc mbt pse acen fgen mynld scc fb gsmi jfc keepr monde rfm urc imi ac aev agi gtcap lpz sm smc ali areit rcr rlc shng smph glo cnvrg bloom plus pgold rrhi wlcon fni ogp

Share Buy-Back Transactions
SM SMPH MEG

Smart Watch 3/25/26
DHI ACEN MRC APX RRHI TEL MWS JGS SGP AG MBT PNB RLC SECB LTG MEG GLO DMC EMI AC ALI

10yr Bond	3/24/20...	3/25/2...	%Chg
PHL	6.989	7.113	1.77%
US	4.358	4.351	-0.16%

Currency Pair	3/24/2...	3/25/2...	%Chg
USD-JPY	158.26	159.09	0.64%
USD-PHP	60.298	60.104	0.06%
USD-CNY	6.8798	6.9021	0.24%
EUR-USD	1.1633	1.1583	-0.35%

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

WEB 11.8

- PhilWeb, Tiger Resort, Leisure & Entertainment to provide an end-to-end online gaming platform for OKADA PLAY—supplying content, technology, and operations—to support Okada Manila's digital expansion,and generate regulated online gaming revenue.

PLUS 17.84

- P**LUS (DigiPlus Interactive) — Expects Full Recovery by Q3–Q4 2026; FY2025 Net Income Flat at ₱12.5B**
- **D**igiPlus President Andy Tsui said the company remains in a "recovery stage" following the BSP directive to delink e-wallets from online gaming platforms in August 2025. "We will probably see full recovery towards maybe the third or fourth quarter of this year," Tsui said. FY2025 net income was flat at ₱12.5B (revenues +12% to ₱84.2B; EBITDA +2% to ₱14.2B) — strong H1 offset the H2 delinking impact. Q4 2025 net income fell 36% YoY to ₱2.5B. More than half of users have shifted to DigiPlus's proprietary platform. DigiPlus is participating in a Senate/PAGCOR technical working group drafting new legislation for tighter gaming regulations, and declared a ₱3.8B dividend (₱0.83/share; record date April 1, payable April 15).
- Analysis: The recovery timeline (Q3–Q4 2026) is credible given the sequential improvement already visible from Q3 to Q4 2025 (net income +43% QoQ). The shift to proprietary platforms removes e-wallet dependency and actually improves DigiPlus's long-term control over the payments ecosystem. The tighter regulatory framework being drafted — with DigiPlus in the working group — could raise compliance barriers that benefit dominant licensed operators like DigiPlus versus unlicensed black market competitors. The ₱3.8B dividend at ₱0.83/share is a significant return of capital from a company with ₱23.4B in cash.

RRHI 39.25

- Robinsons Retail Announces Closure of No Brand Stores in the Philippines

Philippine Bank Bonds Trade Tight Amid Weaker Capital Management

AEV 29.35

- FY25 EPS: ₱3.30 (vs ₱3.25 in FY 2024) EPS: ₱3.30 (up from ₱3.25 in FY 2024).
- Revenue: ₱313.2b (+3.4% from FY 2024)
- Net income: ₱18.3b (+1.0% from FY 2024)
- Profit margin: 5.8% (down from 6.0% in FY24)
- Decrease in margin driven by higher expenses.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

SMPH 19.78

- S**MPH (SM Prime) — ₱300M to Build Covered LRT-2 Antipolo Link to SM Masinag**
- SM Prime will invest approximately ₱300M to construct a covered pedestrian walkway connecting LRT-2's Antipolo terminal station to SM Masinag. The project improves commuter convenience and drives foot traffic directly to SM Masinag — a proven transit-oriented retail strategy.
- Analysis: Transit-oriented development (TOD) is SM Prime's most powerful foot traffic driver. The covered LRT-2 connection to SM Masinag directly captures the passenger flow of one of Metro Manila's busiest commuter rail lines feeding into Antipolo and East Rizal, a high-population catchment. For ₱300M, SM Prime is buying a structural competitive moat: the Masinag mall becomes the default commercial destination for LRT-2 Antipolo commuters. The investment is small relative to SMPH's ₱19.08 share price and nearly ₱1T market cap but strategically valuable for long-term mall revenue.
- **Stance:** Positive incremental for SMPH. TOD investment pays for itself through foot traffic. BUY ON WEAKNESS for SMPH, technically oversold (RSI ~35) with a structurally sound mall-transit portfolio.

ALI 17.98

- ALI / ALP (Ayala Land Premier) — Tops Off Maya Building at Clark Freeport
- Ayala Land Premier's Maya Building in Clark Freeport, Pampanga has achieved its topping-off milestone, a significant construction progress marker for one of Ayala's premium developments in the Clark economic zone.
- **Analysis:** Clark Freeport is one of the most strategically positioned mixed-use development zones in the Philippines proximity to Clark International Airport, Subic port access, and the New Clark City infrastructure investment make it a long-term growth corridor. The Maya Building topping-off confirms Ayala Land Premier is executing on its Clark pipeline despite the macro headwinds. For ALI, construction progress milestones translate to revenue recognition project completions are a near-term catalyst for FY2026 residential revenues.
- **Stance:** Incrementally positive for ALI. Project execution signals amid a price-distressed environment. BUY ON WEAKNESS for ALI remains intact — P/E 6.2x, RSI oversold, 12M target ₱32.05 (+89%).

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

JGS 26.45
Rsi 56

- **JG Summit Holdings says a 3% yoy increase in its recurring net income from continuing operations, totaling P31.9B for FY25. This was primarily supported by growing demand for travel and leisure alongside strong consumption.**

- **JGS (JG Summit Holdings) — FY2025 Recurring Net Income +3% to ₱31.9B; Headline Swings to ₱87.9B Loss on Petrochemical Exit**
- **JG Summit reported a 3% increase in recurring net income from continuing operations to ₱31.9B in 2025, supported by strong travel and leisure demand. Consolidated revenues from ongoing businesses rose 9% to ₱368.6B, driven by double-digit growth in its airline and real estate businesses and steady volume gains in food and beverage.**
- **Headline net income swung to a loss due to the petrochemical business exit — but recurring earnings from continuing operations were healthy at ₱31.9B.**
- **CEB led growth with revenue +14% to ₱119.9B and net income ₱12.3B.**
- **RLC posted revenue +13% to ₱48.4B, net income +8% to ₱13.5B.**
- **Analysis:** The petrochemical shutdown (JGSPC) created a massive one-time headline loss that obscures the genuine strength of JGS's core portfolio — airline (CEB), food (URC), and real estate (RLC) all delivered solid results. The petrochemical exit removes a structurally challenged, capital-intensive business that was dragging on returns. Going forward, JGS is a leaner, more consumer-focused conglomerate with CEB, URC, and RLC as its three main earnings engines. The near-term risk: CEB's 2026 earnings are under direct fuel price pressure following the Middle East shock. URC faces elevated input costs (coffee). The 3% recurring earnings growth is the right baseline to focus on.
- **Stance:** MONITOR-ACCUMULATE JGS on weakness. Petrochemical exit cleans up the portfolio. The 2026 earnings story is CEB fuel recovery + RLC execution + URC cost management.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

FGEN 17.00

- **First Gen Corp FY25 attributable recurring net income for 2025 at US$264M (Php 15.2B) Company generated US$906M (Php 52.1B) in revenues for 2025, a 6% increase of US$49M (Php 3.2B)**
- **FGEN (First Gen Corp.) — FY2025 Recurring Net Income +8% to $264M (₱15.2B); Hydropower +73%**
- First Gen posted an 8% increase in attributable recurring net income to $264M in 2025, supported by higher electricity sales driven by stronger hydropower output. The hydro platform posted a 73% increase in earnings to $19M, supported by a fivefold rise in contributions from the 132MW Pantabangan-Masiway power plant.
- Stronger water levels, increased irrigation, and improved contract prices drove hydro outperformance. This offset weaker earnings from EDC's geothermal and wind portfolio, where lower WESM prices and maintenance costs weighed on results.
- **Analysis:** This is a clean result — the hydro outperformance (+73%) more than offset the gas and geothermal softness, demonstrating the value of a diversified generation portfolio across fuel types. In the current energy shock environment, First Gen's largely gas-fired and hydro-based portfolio positions it well versus pure coal or oil-dependent generators. The 8% recurring income growth is steady and reliable. The key watchpoint in 2026: gas supply security (Malampaya) amid Middle East disruptions to LNG spot markets, and WESM price trends as demand normalizes post-summer.
- S**tance:** ACCUMULATE FGEN. Hydro portfolio is a structural strength. Gas supply security is the 2026 watch variable. FGEN has one of the cleaner generation profiles during a fossil fuel price shock.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

MER 603.50

- **MER (Meralco) — Peso Weakness Driving Generation Cost Pressures; 60% of Power Costs Dollar-Denominated**
- **M**eralco warned that a weaker peso is putting upward pressure on power generation costs. "A depreciation of the peso will put upward pressure on power rates, in particular, the generation charge," said Meralco VP Lawrence Fernandez. Nearly 60% of Meralco's cost of purchased power is dollar-denominated, largely consisting of imported coal and gas. MGEN President Emmanuel Rubio added: "The impact of a weaker peso goes well beyond new power investments — it affects the entire energy value chain and is broadly inflationary."
- **Analysis:** This is a critical macro pass-through story. With the peso at 59.94 (and having touched 60.30 last week), every centavo depreciation flows directly into Meralco's generation charge — which accounts for more than half of consumer electricity bills. The compound effect: oil/LNG prices already elevated, AND a weaker peso amplifying the dollar cost of imported fuels. April power bills will be materially higher than March. For MER as a stock, the generation cost pass-through is actually neutral to earnings (costs pass through to consumers via ERC-approved rate adjustments), but it creates real inflationary pressure and consumer spending headwinds that affect MER's distribution volume growth. For MTerra Solar — every peso of domestic solar generation reduces fuel import dependence.
- **Stance:** ACCUMULATE MER on weakness. Generation cost pass-through protects earnings. MTerra Solar buildout is the long-term structural play on energy import cost reduction. Near-term: watch April rate announcement

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

ACEN

- **ACEN — Secures ₱4.78B Japanese Bank Loan for 100MW Bijapur Wind Project, India**
- ACEN secured a green term loan of 7.517 billion Indian rupees (~₱4.78B) from Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group and Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp. through its Diyos Renewables India unit, for the 100MW initial phase of the Bijapur Wind project in Karnataka. The project has a PPA with SJVN Ltd., a government-owned entity under India's Ministry of Power. Target commissioning: 2027. Expected annual generation: 330 million kWh; 300,000 tons CO_2 avoided. India now accounts for 40% of ACEN's net attributable international capacity. Shares rose 3.75% to ₱2.77.
- Analysis: Securing Japanese project finance (MUFG + SMBC) for a greenfield wind project in India is a significant credibility validation — two of the world's largest banks have assessed the project and ACEN's India platform as financeable. ACEN now owns 100% of a 1,059MW India RE platform (consolidated from UPC Renewables in February 2026) plus a 7GW development pipeline. India is targeting 500GW of RE by 2030 with 25-year government-backed offtakes — structurally one of the most attractive RE markets in Asia. ACEN at ₱2.77 (+3.75% on the news) is discounting the India growth option despite a 7GW pipeline and demonstrated financing execution.
- **Stance:** ACCUMULATE ACEN. India wind financing validation + 7GW pipeline + 40% international capacity exposure to a high-growth market = compelling long-term re-rating opportunity.

DNL 3.69

- DNL (D&L Industries) — Sees Supply Risks; Inventory Good for 74 Days
- D&L Industries flagged supply chain risks from the Middle East conflict but disclosed that current inventory covers approximately 74 days — above the government's emergency benchmark. Key inputs for D&L (oleochemicals, specialty chemicals) are sourced from the Middle East and Southeast Asia, making it directly exposed to supply disruptions.
- Analysis: 74 days of inventory is a meaningful buffer, it provides operational continuity through the critical May–June window when Middle East clarity is expected (Semirara coal auction, US-Iran 5-day pause outcome). D&L's margin profile is more sensitive to input cost inflation than supply disruption at current inventory levels. The risk escalates if conflict continues past June. D&L's specialty chemicals business (food, personal care inputs) makes it a bellwether for broader inflationary transmission through the consumer goods supply chain.
- **Stance:** MONITOR for DNL. 74-day inventory provides short-term comfort. Watch May-June conflict trajectory for Q2 margin guidance. Input cost pass-through capability is the key earnings variable.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

RRHI

- RRHI (Robinsons Retail) — Exits No Brand; Closes All 11 Stores by June 2026 RRHI will close its 11 No Brand standalone stores nationwide by end-June 2026, citing shifting consumer preferences. No Brand accounts for approximately 0.2% of annual net sales and a minimal share of total assets — the closures are not expected to materially affect financial performance. The Gokongwei-led retailer introduced No Brand in 2019 through a master franchise with South Korea's Emart.
- **Analysis:** A sensible portfolio cleanup of a concept that "fell short of expectations" in the Philippine market. The Korean discount format (minimalist packaging, private label basics) didn't translate well to Philippine consumer preferences, which favor branded products and traditional wet/dry market formats. The financial impact is genuinely immaterial (0.2% of net sales). The strategic read-through: RRHI is sharpening its focus on proven formats Robinsons Supermarket, Shopwise, The Marketplace, and Uncle John's that have demonstrated sustainable returns. In an inflationary fuel shock environment, focusing on staples/essentials formats over discretionary specialty formats is the right call.
- **Stance:** NEUTRAL event for RRHI. Immaterial financial impact. Portfolio cleanup is positive for long-term format clarity. Watch RRHI for potential re-rating as a defensive consumer staples play in the current inflationary environment.

CEB / PAL — Both Carriers Confirm Fuel Supply Secured; PAL Through June, CEB Through April (Working on May+)

- Philippine Airlines confirmed it has secured "sufficient jet fuel supply to support scheduled operations, including long-haul flights, for the foreseeable future." Cebu Pacific disclosed it has fuel supply secured through end-April and is working on supply for May and beyond. PAL President Richard Nuttall said domestic fuel shipments are secured through June. However, "beyond May to June, we don't have visibility, and everybody is looking to source fuel beyond that." Some countries have started rationing the amount of fuel foreign airlines can purchase.
- **Analysis:** The supply disclosures are reassuring for the near term but the "beyond June, no visibility" statement from PAL's President is the real news — it flags that the critical H2 2026 operating period has no fuel security clarity yet. CEB's fuel security through April (with May procurement in progress) is consistent with its 73% domestic route mix and 72% NEO fleet efficiency. PAL's long-haul exposure to the US/Canada (stable fuel markets) partially protects its international operations. The government's 45-day national oil reserve (per Marcos) and the strategic petroleum reserve discussions are the systemic backdrop. The Marcos comment that grounding is a "distinct possibility" remains the tail risk.
- **Stance:** NEUTRAL to MONITOR for both CEB and PAL. Near-term fuel secured. Mid-year visibility is limited. The most important catalyst is whether Brent de-escalates sustainably before June.